small, diaphanous clouds between stars are vast seas of immensely distant stars …

For centuries, the world has continued to change and expand around us. We see further, understand it better and are astonished by its variety, by the limitations of the images we had of it. The description we manage to produce to account for it becomes increasingly rarefied, yet simple.

We are akin to small, blind moles underground who know little or nothing about the world. But we continue to learn …

But all the story of the night told over
And all their minds transfigured so together
More witnesseth than fancy's images
And grows to something of great constancy;
But, howsoever, strange and admirable.[2]